

ETS aviation's carbon leakage risk downgraded

送信者: POLITICO Pro Morning Mobility Europe 受信日時: 2026-07-14 14:01

【要点】

- ・ EUが排出権取引制度（ETS）を域外国際線に拡大した場合、炭素漏出は対象排出量の約3%程度に留まるという新研究が発表された。
- ・ ETSの拡大に対し、運送労組は反対しており、主な懸念は乗客が高いコストを避けてEU域外の経由地を選択することで排出量が削減されず移転するだけという点である。
- ・ ETSの完全拡大は年間約143億ユーロの収入を生み出す一方、EU出発便のみの適用なら約90億ユーロの収入で炭素漏出を1.9%に抑制できる。
- ・ 距離制限設計など中間的な選択肢により、出発便収入の96%を保持しながら炭素漏出を1.1%に削減することが可能である。

【メール原文】

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Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

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SNEAK PEEK

— Extending the Emissions Trading System to international flights would generate only limited carbon leakage, according to a new study.

— German automakers are asking workers to do more with less pay to alleviate layoffs.

— Dunkirk has become a blueprint for Europe's reindustrialization drive, with Brussels hoping it can be replicated across the bloc with the Industrial Accelerator Act.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

ETS EXPANSION CARBON RISK DOWNGRADED: If the European Union decides to extend the Emissions Trading System to all flights beyond the bloc, the resulting carbon leakage would amount to only around 3 percent of the emissions covered, according to a new study. The 30-page report, released today by

the International Council on Clean Transportation, concludes that “carbon leakage risk should not deter EU ETS scope expansion.” However, transport unions are against any extension.

Why it matters: One of the main arguments against extending the ETS beyond EU-only flights is that passengers might flee higher costs by choosing non-EU stopovers for long-haul journeys, shifting emissions rather than reducing them. Major carriers, including Lufthansa and Air France-KLM, have repeatedly warned of this risk.

Ten shades of ETS: The ICCT study, seen by Tommaso ahead of publication, models 10 possible ETS scenarios, ranging from maintaining the current intra-European scope to a full extension covering both departing and arriving international flights. Between those extremes are eight intermediate options.

Full scope: Extending the ETS to all non-EU flights would generate “annual revenue to an estimated €14.3 billion at a leakage rate of 3.1 percent,” according to the study, which assumes an ETS carbon price of €70 per ton of CO₂ (compared with current prices of around €80). Applying the ETS only to flights departing the EU would generate about €9 billion while limiting carbon leakage to 1.9 percent.

Halfway solutions: To further reduce carbon leakage — while also limiting the economic impact on airlines — the Commission could adopt “distance-based designs,” such as pricing only the first 7,500 kilometers of every departing flight. According to the report, this option would retain “96 percent of the all-departing-flights revenue while holding leakage to just 1.1 percent.” Other options would further reduce both revenues and leakage by applying only a fraction of the full ETS charge.

What about employment leakage? Opponents of the ETS extension gained support this week from the European Transport Workers’ Federation, which on Monday wrote to Commission President Ursula von der Leyen urging the Berlaymont “not to propose an extension ... without first establishing, through a comprehensive impact assessment, that the measure will produce real global emissions reductions and will not lead to significant carbon, traffic or employment leakage.”

ETF against the ETS: The letter, seen by Tommaso, argues that including all EU departures in the ETS would “further strengthen the competitive advantage already enjoyed by many connecting itineraries routed through third-country hubs.” The letter, signed by ETF General Secretary Livia Spera, adds: “Aviation workers cannot be expected to bear the cost of climate measures through job losses, outsourcing, wage pressure or the relocation of activities outside Europe.”

CARS

WORK MORE TO SAVE JOBS, SAYS VW BOSS: Volkswagen CEO Oliver Blume told employees on Monday that the company could cut fewer than the expected 100,000 jobs by 2030 if they accept lower wages or longer working hours, according to WELT .

An additional lever: “Personnel costs are calculated on the basis of labor costs in addition to the number of employees. We must also pull this lever,” Blume said in an internal interview posted on the company’s intranet. “In the end, this will determine how much staff reduction is necessary to keep pace with the competition in terms of costs.”

Not the only one: Mercedes-Benz CEO Ola Källenius also said the 35-hour-work week must come to an end. “We should work more for the same pay in all areas,” he told workers last month .

The bigger context: Germany’s industrial base is hollowing out as automakers and their suppliers shed jobs. The industry is struggling to keep pace with Chinese rivals in the transition to electric vehicles, as

well as sluggish demand and rising tariffs.

“Despite better products, we cannot keep up with the export models from China in terms of costs and prices. We can already see today in the competition how quickly it can slip into the loss zone,” Källenius said.

MERZ TAKES AIM AT CHINESE CURRENCY DEVALUATION: German Chancellor Friedrich Merz had harsh words for China during a speech in Cologne on Monday, saying: “We have underestimated the power and economic strength of the People’s Republic of China for a long time.” The remarks come as the German leader struggles to address the country’s economic malaise — an issue the far-right is using to galvanize voters.

Why it matters: Beijing is artificially devaluing its currency, which in turn makes it cheaper for its companies to export goods like cars at lower prices.

What Merz wants: “We can be the best we can be, the most competitive, the most innovative. But if you’re dealing with a competitor who artificially undervalues their currency — and they do — then you can’t survive that competition. We also need a monetary policy dialogue with the People’s Republic of China,” he said in a Q&A session at the opening of the Adenauer School of Governance at the University of Cologne. “We are facing a fundamental, strategic decision with China.”

PORTS

DUNKIRK’S INDUSTRIAL RENAISSANCE: Northern France’s biggest port has become a blueprint for Europe’s reindustrialization drive, with Brussels hoping its mix of coordinated public investment and industrial policy can be replicated across the bloc through the Industrial Accelerator Act, our colleague Aude Van den Hove reports.

Acceleration areas: The IAA proposal combines “Made in Europe” preferences, tougher conditions for companies benefiting from foreign subsidies and the concept of Industrial Manufacturing Acceleration Areas. According to the Commission’s proposal, EU countries will have 12 months after the act enters into force to designate these acceleration areas, where most permitting issues would already have been resolved and companies can move straight in.

Commission’s objective: Projects within an acceleration area should benefit from faster permitting, improved coordination, and better access to infrastructure, financing, and skilled workers.

Energy and logistics: French nuclear group Orano recently chose Dunkirk for Neomat, its joint venture with the Chinese XTC New Energy, to build new battery cathodes. Philippe Hatron, executive vice president of Orano Battery Program, said that connections by road, rail and sea were important factors in deciding to invest in Dunkirk. “Having access to carbon-free electricity at a competitive cost was an important factor,” Hatron said.

Port authority: One of Dunkirk’s biggest advantages is that most industrial land is owned by the port, allowing projects to move far faster than in places where ownership is fragmented. “We are leveraging our land assets for port development,” said Maurice George, chairman of the executive board of Dunkerque-Port. This is about dedicating land for logistics facilities or for industrial zones to “accommodate all the components of a modern industrial and port-based economy,” he added.

Shovel-ready: The port is preparing “shovel-ready” industrial sites for manufacturers. Available land is connected to roads, the grid and water. Environmental permitting is also done in advance. “We’re doing

this in advance or in parallel so that manufacturers have nothing left to do but set up shop.”

Read more about it [here](#) .

RAIL

NEW RAIL ENTRANTS WARN ITALY OVER INTERCITY TENDER: Independent rail operators are accusing Italy of backtracking on commitments made to Brussels after they say Rome changed the rules for its upcoming long-distance public service rail tender, potentially paving the way for a single nationwide contract instead of multiple lots.

What changed: Lobby group Allrail says Italy had initially planned to divide the Intercity Day and Night public service contract into three separate lots to encourage competition and comply with EU commitments under its National Recovery and Resilience Plan. But a June decree amended the law to allow the services to be tendered as a single lot, while postponing the tender until December.

The concern: According to Allrail, awarding the contract as a single package would make it harder for new operators to compete and could conflict with the EU’s Public Service Obligation Regulation, which encourages authorities to divide contracts into appropriate lots to promote competition.

What’s at stake: The association warns the move could trigger legal challenges, infringement proceedings by the European Commission and even financial consequences under Italy’s Recovery and Resilience Plan if Brussels concludes Rome has failed to honor its commitments. It is urging the government to revert to the original multi-lot structure.

The Italian transport and infrastructure ministry did not immediately respond to POLITICO’s request for comment.

PIT STOPS

The Council gave its final approval to the air passenger rights reform.

President Donald Trump on Monday said the U.S. will take over the Strait of Hormuz — and will be reimbursed “at the rate of 20% on all cargo shipped.” From us.

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